

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 8 5
♥ K 7
♦ 9 7 4 3
♣ 8 7 2

♠ A 10 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ A Q 10 2

♣ Q 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 6 4

♥ Q J 10 5 3

♦ 8 5

♣ A 10 4

♠ K 7 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ K J 6

♣ K J 9 5

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥Q

on the ♥Q, then again on trick two when you play the ♥K. AND HE WILL STILL HAVE HIS ♥A when you switch to another suit. He will have time to drive out the ♣A while he still has ♥s stopped.

It was a good thing you held the ♥K rather than declarer, but it is a nuisance that you must get out of the way on the very first trick.

[showcards W:HQ N:H4]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥Q, dummy played the ♥4

Play the ♥K.

Admittedly you have a terrible hand. But that's no reason to be careless. **YOU** can beat this contract, but you have to do it right now by unblocking the ♥K. If declarer holds up you will continue with your ♥7 and partner will establish his suit while he still has the ♣A for an entry. If declarer doesn't hold up it will be just as bad for him.

But suppose you say "Well, partner's ♥Q is just as good as my ♥K so I'll just save the King for later" as you play low. Declarer will love you. He will hold up

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q J 10 7

♥ A 5

♦ K 4 2

♣ A J 2

♠ K 6 2

♥ K Q 3

♦ 10 9 8 5

♣ 9 7 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 5 4

♥ 10 8 7 4

♦ Q J 6

♣ K 6 5 4

♠ 9 8 3

♥ J 9 6 2

♦ A 7 3

♣ Q 10 8

West

1 ♠

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♥2

If declarer played low on the first trick you would win the ♥Q, then play the ♥K to dummy's ♥A.

[showcards W:H2 N:HA]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥2, dummy played the ♥A

Play the ♥Q (or ♥K).

You know partner has a 4-card ♥ suit, (he led the deuce), and you know it is headed by an honor. You hope the honor is the ♥J, but in any case you must get your high ♥s out of the way.

Declarer will probably come to his hand and then take a ♠ finesse. You win the ♠K, take your other high ♥, then lead your ♥3 toward your partner.

As you see, partner did hold the ♥ J 9, so your side wins 3 ♥ tricks.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 6 5

♥ A K 3

♦ Q 7 2

♣ 8 4 2

♠ K 9 2

♥ Q 10 9 8 5

♦ A 6

♣ A 10 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 7

♥ 6 4 2

♦ 10 9 8 5

♣ 9 7 3

♠ Q 4 3

♥ J 7

♦ K J 4 3

♣ K Q J 5

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ 5

wins a high ♥ he will play another ♠ through dummy's ♠ K 9 to your ♠ A J. Once you clear dummy's ♠ away partner will win another ♥ and be able to cash his last ♠.

[showcards W:S5 N:S2]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ 5, dummy played the ♠ 2

Play the ♠ 7.

Partner's low ♠ lead tells you he has an honor in the suit, so it must be either the ♠ Q or the ♠ 10. South's jump to 2NT makes it almost certain that he holds the ♠ Q, so you can figure partner probably led from ♠ 10 x x 5.

Apply the Rule of 11. 11 minus 5 = 6 cards higher than the ♠ 5 held by dummy, you, and declarer.

Since you can see 5 of the 6 you conclude that that declarer will have to play his ♠ Q to beat your ♠ 7.

South will take the ♠ Q at trick 1, but when West

Note that if dummy's ♠ 9 was played you would cover with your ♠ J, leading to the same situation.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 10
♥ K 4 3
♦ K Q 9 2
♣ Q 8 5

♠ K 8 5 2

♥ J 10 6 5 2

♦ 6 4

♣ 9 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 6 4

♥ 9 8

♦ A 5

♣ A J 10 7 4 2

♠ 9 7 3

♥ A Q 7

♦ J 10 8 7 3

♣ K 6

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by West

Lead: ♥5

whether you play ♥A or ♥Q to the first trick; you will win your two top cards and then play your small one back to North.

So assume West actually holds the ♥K x x. If you play the ♥A to trick one, then lead ♥Q, West will hold up on the second trick, and win the third ♥. Then, when you win your ♣K you will not have a ♥ to return to partner and declarer will make the contract.

So what happens if you play the ♥Q at trick one? West could still make the contract by holding up, **but he will be afraid to do so**. After all, from his perspective it looks like North probably holds the ♥A and he will be afraid of losing the first 5 ♥ tricks, perhaps even when the ♣K finessing is working!

[showcards W:H5 N:H8]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥8

Play the ♥Q.

The Rule of Eleven tells you there are 6 cards in East, South and West that are higher than the ♥5. You can see 5 of them, so that leaves just one of them for West.

North cannot have all three of the outstanding honors, because from ♥K J 10 x x his correct lead would be the Jack. So you can deduce that West must hold exactly one of ♥K, ♥J, or ♥10.

If his honor is not the ♥K then it won't matter whether you play ♥A or ♥Q to the first trick; you will win your two top cards and then play your small one back to North.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 7 4
♥ A K 4
♦ 10 9 8 4
♣ 10 8 4 2

♠ Q 10 9 6 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ K J 3

♣ J 6



♠ K 5
♥ Q J 9 7 2
♦ A Q 6
♣ 9 7 3

♠ A J 8 3

♥ 10 6

♦ 7 5 2

♣ A K Q 5

West	North	East	South
------	-------	------	-------

Pass

1 ♠

2 ♥

1 ♣

3 ♠

All Pass

3 ♠ by North

Lead: ♥ Q

♦ 9 and your side will collect 3 ♦ tricks to go with your 2 ♥ s.

[showcards W:HQ N:H6]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥ Q, dummy played the ♥ 6

Overtake with the ♥ K.

Your side needs to take 5 tricks to defeat this contract. Two of them will be ♥ s, but it doesn't look like you can win any ♣ s or ♠ s.

That means you need to win 3 ♦ tricks and the only way that can happen is if you play ♦ s from your side.

So win the first ♥ K (so partner will know you also have the ♥ A), and play the ♦ 10. Presumably North will play an honor, but East will take the trick and put you back on lead with your ♥ A. You play the

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 3
 ♥ K Q J 6
 ♦ A K Q 10 5
 ♣ 6 2

♠ 10
 ♥ 7 3 2
 ♦ 9 8 6 3
 ♣ Q 7 5 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 7 5 2
 ♥ A 10 9 5 4
 ♦ J
 ♣ K 10 8

♠ A K Q 8 6 4
 ♥ 8
 ♦ 7 4 2
 ♣ A J 9

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	1 ♥	1 ♠
4 ♥			
All Pass			

4 ♥ by East

Lead: ♠ A

happen is for you to ruff partner's ♠ K with an otherwise useless trump. You still get your two ♠ winners (sort of) but now you get to play a ♣ through East's ♣ K at trick 3.

[showcards W:SK N:SJ]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ A, then the ♠ K. Dummy follows suit and it is your play to the second trick.

Ruff partner's ♠ K.

It is obvious that your side can only get 2 ♠ tricks. And assuming that East has the Ace of trumps you will not make a single trick in the red suits. So you need to make 2 ♣ tricks.

If partner has the ♣ A K then he will take them, but if he has the ♣ A J he cannot win 2 ♣ tricks from his side.

To allow for this situation it will be better to play ♣s from your side of the table, and the way to make that